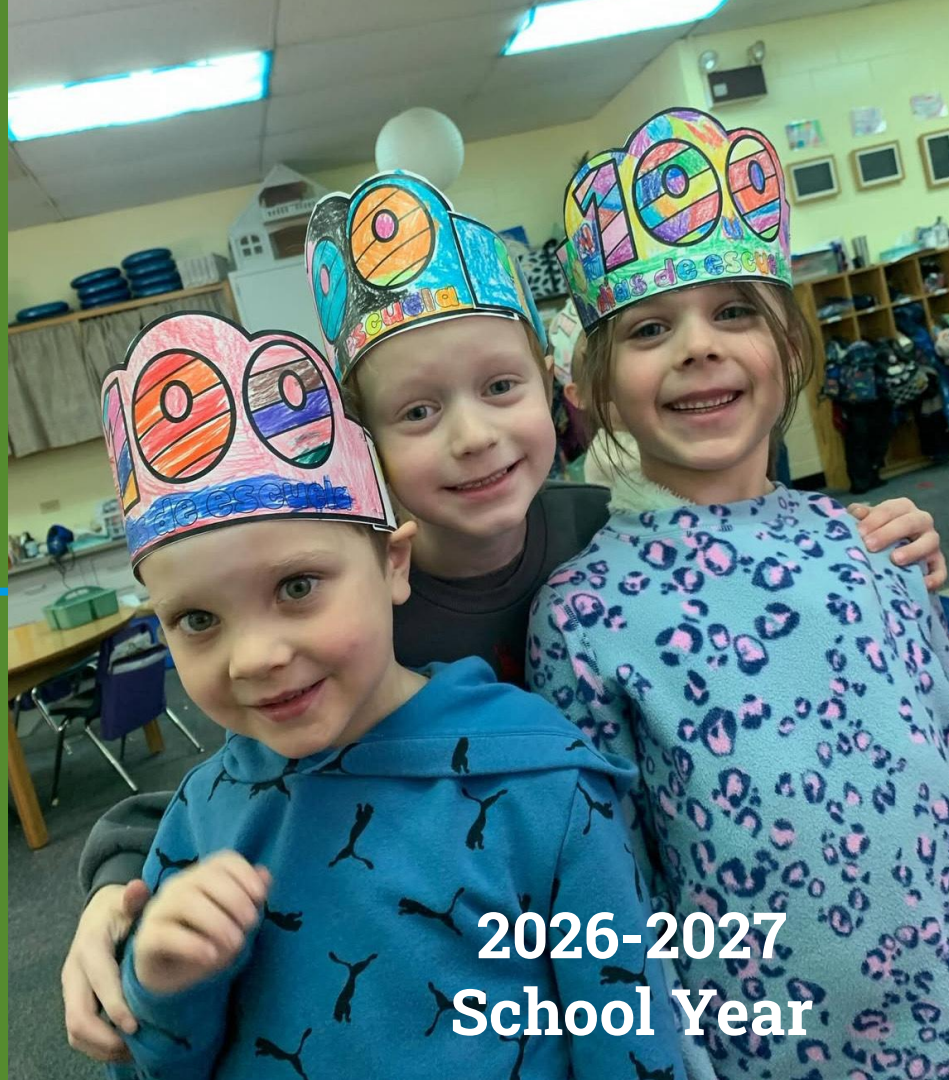
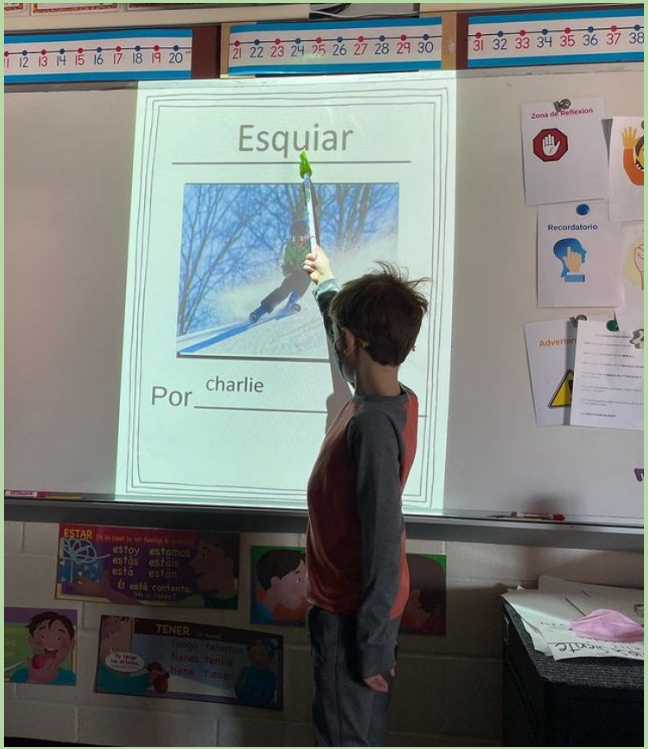
MMUUSD Spanish Immersion Program





Agenda

Introduction/Welcome

About the program
- Mission
- What is Spanish Immersion?
- Supporting all students

Enrollment
- Timeline
- School Percentages
- FAQ

Spanish Immersion Team Q&A Panel

We at MMUUSD recognize language immersion education as a pathway for our students to become bilingual and biliterate, achieve academic excellence, and act as culturally competent citizens of the world.



+45,000,000

That’s how many people in the U.S. speak Spanish...it is no longer a “foreign language”

Cognitive benefits of an immersion program:

- Cross-cultural communication skills
- Better problem-solving skills
- Flexible thinking
- Global awareness
- Ease of third language acquisition



Immersion

What's that?

- **Grades K-2**
  - 80% of core academic instruction occurs in Spanish.
  - The other 20% is English phonics instruction and support in transferring literacy skills across both language
- **Grades 3 and 4**
  - 60% of core academic instruction occurs in Spanish and 40% in English.
- **Grade 5 and Beyond**
  - Students are provided Spanish enrichment opportunities at their level
- Unified Arts classes (Art, Music, PE etc.) in all grades are taught in English





Curriculum

What do we teach and how?

- District literacy and math curriculums are available in Spanish, science units are translated into Spanish.
- Literacy curriculum follows the science of reading with an emphasis on phonemic awareness and phonics. Many of the reading strategies are transferable between both languages, and non transferable skills are taught separately.
- SI teachers use many of the same practices as teachers in English classrooms. For example, we teach reading through explicit phonics instruction, phonemic awareness, read alouds, guided reading, and book clubs.
- SI teachers use visuals, movement, objects, songs, and lots of repetition to help students learn content in an immersion setting
- Students begin receiving English phonics in kindergarten.

Supporting All Students

Tier 1: Universal Core Instruction
The classroom teacher delivers high-quality, universal **first instruction** in Spanish to all students
Tier 2: Targeted Supports
Teachers and specialists use assessment data to **reteach and support** students needing more time for grade-level skills.
Tier 3: Intensive Remediation
Tier 3 remediation is **targeted and intensive support** given to students who need extra time and support beyond what is provided in regular classroom instruction in English and/or Spanish.
Special Education

Spanish Immersion is for any student whose family wishes for them to join. In Spanish Immersion we support all students in accessing a biliterate education. Students receive whole group instruction in both English and Spanish. When students need further support, we utilize Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) to ensure all needs are met.

Program Growth



Year	South End	North End
2017-2018		Kindergarten
2018-2019		K and First Grade
2019-2020		K, First and Second Grade
2020-2021	Kindergarten	Kindergarten - Third Grade
2021-2022	Kindergarten First Grade	Kindergarten - Fourth Grade
2022-2023	K, First and Second Grade	Kindergarten - Fifth Grade
2023-2024	Kindergarten First Grade Second Grade Third Grade	Kindergarten First Grade Second Grade Third Grade Fourth Grade Fifth Grade
2024 - 2025	Kindergarten - Fourth Grade	Kindergarten - Fifth Grade
2025 and beyond	Kindergarten - Fifth Grade	Kindergarten - Fifth Grade

Enrollment Timeline



Incorporated into the MMMUSD School Choice process

March 6th- April 3rd Registration

April 3rd School Choice Applications Due

April 17th Families informed via US Mail

Forms located in Powerschool

How the lottery works...



- Priority is given to families with a native or heritage Spanish speaker in the home.
- Next, lottery spots in the programs are established per school community based on total enrollment for the class.

School	Students
RES	61%
SMS	16%
BPMS	22%

South End

School	Students
JES	67%
UCS	33%

North End

Final placement will be done via a

lottery process

*tuition slots only available if no waitlist

FAQ

Can we try it out and withdraw at any time?
The impact of an immersion program takes years to build and thus a commitment to being in the program long-term is important for potential students.

How quickly will my child acquire Spanish?
Throughout Kindergarten and 1st Grade, students build strong listening skills and begin speaking in words, phrases and eventually sentences. By 2nd and 3rd grade students can produce Spanish in both academic and interpersonal conversations, presentations and writing.

Will my child have the opportunity to interact with other students in the English classes?
Spanish Immersion classes are integrated into all other parts of the school. Students eat lunch, have recess, and special events with their English peers.

When will my child learn to read in English?
Some students learn to read in English on their own or at home. All Spanish immersion students will begin English phonics instruction in Kindergarten. If there are any areas of growth identified, an educational support team may choose to introduce English intervention earlier on.

Questions